

A
SERMON

Preach'd upon the Occasion of the

Anniversary Thanksgiving

Of the Fifth of *November*, 1706.

AT THE

CHURCH of *KENSINGTON*.

By NATH. HOUGH, M. A. Chaplain to the
Countess FAUCONBERG, Lecturer of *Ken-
sington*, and Fellow of *Jesus College* in
Cambridge.

L O N D O N :

Printed by *W. B.* for ALEXANDER BOSVILE at the
Dial and Bible over against *St. Dunstan's Church*
in *Fleetstreet*. 1707.

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK A SERMON
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TO THE
GENTLEMEN
AND
PARISHIONERS
OF
KENSINGTON.

THIS is the second Instance of my Service made publick upon an Occasion of this Nature. As none can be more pleased with the double Blessing of the Day, than your selves, being the best Subjects to Her MAJESTY, as well as the nearest Neighbours to Her Court: So I have this farther Accession to the general Joy, viz. As I have a small Opportunity of shewing, at your own Request, how much I am,

Your most obliged Servant,

NATH. HOUGH.

PSALM CXXIV. v. 2. and part of the 3^d.

If it had not been the Lord who was on our side, when Men rose up against Us; Then They had swallowed Us up quick.

WHOEVER compares this *Psalm* and this *Solemnity* together, will find the main *Lines* of the one, and the chief *Circumstances* of the other exactly agreeable. Had We Who live since the *Deliverance* of this Day was wrought, been endued with the *Divine Author's* Inspiration, we could scarce have pitch'd upon more apposite Words to express the surprizing *Manner* of it. *Swallowing up quick, the Kindling of our Enemies Wrath, the Torrents*

being like to go over our Soul, our Escaping like a Bird out of the Fowler's Snare: All these are Expressions so pat for the present Season, that whilst We sing an Hymn, we seem likewise to read a Prophecy. Our Enemies have took effectual Care that the ill Character in this Psalm should not pass unfulfill'd: And I hope we, for our parts, shall not be wanting to make good the pious Acknowledgments of it, saying, Blessed be the Lord who hath not given us as a Prey to their Teeth.

But perhaps We are got so deep into a *Vein of Thanksgiving for Modern Mercies: Our Streets* are so full of Triumph, and our *Churches of Praise* for the *Victories* of the past Year, that either no *Place* is left for the Recollection of any former *Blessings*, or at least little or no *Taste*. The present *Solemnity* finds our Gratitude to such a degree exhausted, that tho' at the utmost 'tis but an *insufficient Return*, yet at this *Juncture* it must needs be more so, considering how our late *Successes* have already drain'd our very best *Acknowledgments*. Thus the *Blessings* of one Age do a seeming Injury to *Those* of the foregoing; And immediate *Deliverances* bear down so strongly, as to make distant ones shrink out of *Notice*.

Happy We, who have such an agreeable *Excuse* for being *imperfectly* thankful: I mean, when *Modern Favours* are so great, as necessarily to impair the Memory of the *Antient*. Tho' upon second Thoughts this *Excuse* cannot hold, since the Favours lately *received*, and Those at this Time *recollected*, are so much of a Piece, that unless we break the *Chain* of *Providence*, we cannot well pretend to *acknowledge* the one, and yet wholly to *overlook* the other.

'Tis the same *Cause*, the same *Interest* this Year so gloriously *promoted*, which upon this Occasion we congratulate, as *twice* wonderfully *preserved*. The *Reign* of our *gracious Sovereign* directly perpetuates the double *Blessing* which this *Day* boasts of; And (God be praised) We obey a good *Queen*, who nobly maintains the *Reform'd Religion*, which Heaven so *signally* rescued under Her *first Royal Ancestor*.

We cannot then let one *Thanksgiving* jostle out another, when the *Blessings* which occasion them hang, as it were, upon one *Link*, level at the same End, and are so many successive *Proofs* of the same kind and watchful *Providence*. Those *Enemies* of our Faith, who *formerly* fought to

undermine us at Home, now *forcibly attack* us from Abroad: So that whilst We are remembring the successful *Repulse* of their open *Assaults*, it cannot be unseasonable to reflect too upon the happy *Defeat* of their *private* Conspiracies. Nor can *Distance* of Time be any just Reason, why the *One* should be forgot, when the *Other* are celebrated, seeing the Interval cannot seem long from the very first *Reformation*, or betwixt the Reigns of two Glorious *Queens*, whose *Characters* come so near each other, and do so happily resemble.

Easie then it is in the general to vindicate the *Honour* and *Justice* of celebrating this *Day*; but 'tis as *difficult* to determine in what particular Manner it may best be done. To attempt an *Historical Account*, wou'd be to trespass upon this judicious *Audience*, so well acquainted with the known *Matter of Fact*: To aim at an *Elegant Representation*, wou'd be only to fall short of those many Excellent *Pens* which have set the *Fifth of November* in the best *Light* it can bear. For 'tis well known, that this *Festival* fixes not more Calumny upon the Romish *Clergy*, than it has serv'd to shew the *Oratory*, and advance the Credit of *our Own*: And those Designs which rais'd *Horror* in the *Enterprize*, have since produced much *Beauty* in the *Description*.

To these *Admirable Discourses* upon the *Subject*, I do pleasingly remit You; And shall presume only to offer a few plain *Reflections* upon the following Words, *If it had not been*, &c.

The main Observation directly *flowing* from the *Text*, and *properly* suiting the *Solemnity* is This: viz. That the *Defeat* of such desperate *Enterprizes* as proceed from a devilish *Intention*, and are not by any Humane Means to be prevented in the *Execution*, argues the unquestionable Interposal of Divine *Providence*.

The Observation, I think, is *self-evident*; and shines by its own Light: For if we own the Existence of a *Good Being* who loves and preserves Us, and of an *Evil One*, who hates and would destroy Us, where should the One declare his *Providence*, but where the Other discovers his *Malice*? And in what *Cases* can devilish *Malice* be more visibly discover'd, than in *Those*, where the General Ruin of great Numbers of People is design'd, without any *Provocation*, and beyond all *Prevention*? Or where can Divine

Providence more worthily appear, than in baffling those black and barbarous *Attempts*, which at once overcome *Force*, and escapes *Foresight*. Here, if ever, is an important Necessity of *having the Lord on our side*, when an *Insurrection* is so cruel as not to be resisted, and *Destruction* swallows so quick as not to be remedied: Two ugly *Characters* these, which sit close upon the design'd *Tragedy* of this Day: Insomuch that 'tis hard to say whether the *Intention* of it was more inhuman, or the *Execution* in all Appearance more unavoidable.

First the Conspiracy was cruel and inhumane. And where can we find any thing like it either under Heathen Tyrants, or amidst the ten Christian Persecutions? A *compendious* kind of *Martyrdom* This, such as our *Church-Historians* say nothing of. Without the Formality of Fire and a Stake for every single Sufferer, here an entire Nation was to be sent up for a *Burnt-Offering*, and the Body of a People to be sacrificed at once in their *Representatives*. This was a noble *Dispatch* of *Heresy*, compar'd to the dull *Proceedings* of *Queen Mary's* Reign; and the *Reformation* now was like to vanish in a Cloud of Smoke in one instant. The *King* and *Princes* of the Blood, the *Lords* and *Commons* of *England* were at the same Minute to find both *Death* and a *Grave*; And upon the Ruins of one *Pile* was to be rear'd the Tomb of a whole *Kingdom*. Glorious *Mischief*! and what might actually compleat (that which a certain *Emperor* only ineffectually wish'd) the cutting off a *Common-wealth* at one Blow.

Must not this barbarous *Scene*, tho' at a hundred Years distance, move every Heart *entirely English*? How does even the imaginary Slaughter of our worthy Ancestors come cold over our Breasts, and the Blood which we draw from them runs chill upon the Reflection. Had they indeed met with a fair Enemy, and heard any Warning of their Danger, then, no doubt, their native Courage would have left Us as little Cause of Concern, as their Adversaries or Boasting: But for *Valour* and *Bravery* to be blown up by a *scandalous Stratagem*, for *Nobility* and *Honour* to be blasted by an *underground Attempt*, the Thought raises *Indignation* and *Compassion* at once. A *Prince* and the *Peers* of a *Realm* to fall by the Hands of a vile *Incendiary*; *Senators* and wise *Counsellors*, when studying the common *Safety*, to sink into sudden *Ruin*; Persons of the best *Quality* and *Rank* to be swallow'd up in ignominious and undistinguish'd Dust! Who can hear the bare *Mention* without a *Mixture* of Grief and Horror? A *Parliament* in this

dreadful manner *dissolv'd* could forebode no less than Universal Confusion, and the entire Overthrow of *Church and State*.

Let not a *Popish Inquisition*, or a *Parisian Massacre* be any more talk'd of: *Puny Cruelties* these, not worthy to vie with the Wholesale *Execution* of a *Community*: Course and common *Villanies*, much below the *refin'd* and *exquisite* Methods of slaying Numbers in a Moment. Here that *Order* of Men, which is ingenious in all the *Arts* of Ruin, did many degrees outwit it self, and learnt a new way of *consecrating* that sulphurous *Composition* which an Age or two before they had invented. *Wo unto us*: For had the Design taken, *We had been as Sodom, and been made like unto Gomorra*: Each Destruction, as to the *Materials* of it, was very much the same: Theirs only was *rain'd* from Heaven; Ours was to *rise* from the Bowels of the Earth. Perhaps it might have, in the Conclusion, been more tolerable for *Sodom* and *Gomorra* than for Us: Just so much, as 'tis better to fall into the Hands of a merciful *God*, than into Those of Bigotted and Blood-thirsty Men.

Moreover, What upon the Principles of the Romish *Church* must add the finishing Stroke to the *cruel* Fact, was, the downright sending so many guilty Souls into Hell without any Room for *Repentance*, or Possibility of *Redemption*. There could be no *Purgatory* to cleanse Them, unless the *Flames* they were immediately to pass thro' could attain that Effect. No *Masses* to be said for *Hereticks*: Those were more worthily reserv'd for the *Chief Promoters* of this *Catholick Cause*, supposing they should by any means miscarry in it. The *Actors* in this horrid *Scene* had pardon and Indulgence ready, if not the Promise of being *Canoniz'd*; But the poor Sufferers were to perish under a *Curse*, and, as if Death was not enough to expiate their *Heresie*, an *Anathema* too must attend them into the other World. Hard Fate! when the Errors of unhappy *Protestants* are not to be dispersed with their Ashes, but *Excommunications* and *Interdicts* must still pursue them into a miserable Eternity.

The Warmth of this Resentment can want no *Apology*, when we consider farther that no ill *Usage* before-hand gave the least Colour to this unnatural *Conspiracy*. *Subjects* they were, who thus undutifully aim'd at the Life of their *Sovereign*; And Subjects too very tenderly treated, who quietly enjoyed their *Liberties* and *Estates*, and had no Occasion to make them

uneasie, but the clearing of the same *Faith* from *additional* Superstitions, which in *Substance* we jointly believe. Was it fair to destroy their lawful *Prince*, because they were rid of a *Supremacy* which made them meer *Slaves*? Was it just to overturn the antient *Constitution*, because rescued from a *Discipline*, which, if blindly followed, treats them like *Fools*? Or if they were still so much in Love with the Usurpations of the *Popedom*, could not they be content to bear the galling *Yoke* themselves, without compelling others into the same *Bondage*? And compelling them too in such a savage manner, that the Best of the *Kingdom* must be kill'd outright, in Order to enthral the Rest. Their Consciences were full in their own *keeping*, or in that of their *Confessors*; and their usual Violences were not practis'd, tho' to bring them over to a purer *Communion*: Sure then 'twas better for them to enjoy their *Religion* in private, and be peaceable, than to let it come abroad to the Ruin of the *Publick*. We do not find the *Romish Missionaries* are generally so forward as to propagate their Faith Abroad, where there is a Hazard of dying for it: But at Home, where They may profess it without Disturbance, the Death of their own *Countrymen* is not stuck at to make way for its general Reception.

To advance only one Step farther: Let us grant *Popery* for once to be as pure and *Primitive*, as its most zealous Votaries contend, and as *Catholick* too as they could wish to have it; yet it makes the Argument still more guiltily recoil, to carry on a *holy* Cause by impious *Projects*, and to promote a *merciful* Religion by *inhumane* Practices. Lord! how did it ever enter into the Hearts of *Christians*, that a kind Religion which heaps Coals of Fire upon the Heads of Enemies, should do This not in a *moral* Sense to melt and soften, but in a *natural* One to burn and consume. The Spirit of *Jesus* is distinguishable by its ingenuous *Simplicity*: Greater Shame, that *Those* who emphatically stile themselves His *Order*, should be famous for pernicious *Subtlety*, and fatal *Intrigue*! How comes the *Propagation* of the Gospel to be a perfect Contradiction to its *Precepts*, the latter *enjoining* whatever is good and benign, the former *authorising* whatever is cruel and destructive? A strange Way of converting either *Infidels* or *Hereticks*, when the Doctrine of Christ is directly overturn'd in the manner of the *Publication*. Upon all these Accounts, and under all these Views such a *complicated Cruelty* is not to be met with in *Story*; and to dwell longer upon it would be apt only to raise too much *Heat*, and run us upon the Hazard of losing *Temper*.

2ndly, The *Conspiracy* was to all appearance as *certain* in Execution as in Intention, *cruel*. The *Seat* of this clandestine Wickedness was dark and obscure, as far remov'd from any mortal *Eye*, as one would have thought the Mischief it self was from Humane *Invention*. The *Situation* of the Place, as well as *Nature* of the Fact, shew'd that it came too near the Dominions of the *Prince of Darkness*: And He sure was too well pleased with the Infernal *Plot* ever to give us the least Intimation. More likely it was the *Evil Angels* should be Ministers and Accomplices, than Betrayers and Divulgers of the *Hellish Deed*, too bad sure ever to be begun without their *Instigation*, or to be accomplish'd without their *Assistance*. In one Sense truly this *Pit* which They had digg'd for Us was unlike the *Bottomless One*: The Access to it was difficult, the Avenue narrow, and hard it was to find the Way down to *these Chambers of Death*: But, in another Respect it resembled it too much, namely, that being once sunk into the *sad Abyss*, there could be no Hope of Return. How then must the secret *Villany* but needs succeed, which no prying *Sagacity* could discover, and from which no appearing *Strength* deliver Us? What Arbitrary Power *above* a *Parliament* was ever so dangerous, as this insidious Design which in another Sense lay *beneath* It?

The *immediate Agents* were not more cunning in the Contrivance, than obstinate in the Concealment. For apprehending (as truly they had Cause enough) that Nature would shrink at the *forbidding Fact*, and Humanity not be able to hold out, they thought no Course so sure as fulfilling this Morning's *second Lesson*, and binding themselves (like the Way-layers of *St. Paul*) under Oath and Imprecation. Religion was speciously call'd in to back the accurs'd *Confederacy*, to stifle the faint Motions of Compassion or Conscience, and to gloss over a Crime too gross to go down, if not *superficially sanctified*: And (what is Ill beyond all Epithets) the *Holy Sacrament* was made the Test of the Treason, and the sacred Seal of the New *Covenant of Grace* made to confirm *One* of Treachery and *Malice*. If we count it so bad to prostitute this *Institution*, even for a *temporal Preferment*; What must it be to make it jointly the Cement, and the Cover of such an *Infernal Machination*? No Thought then but the fatal *Train* must take, when the Mouths of the wicked *Associates* were as cautiously stopp'd, as the very Passages tending down into the dark *Apartment* it self. So far were the *Conspirators* from any Fear of *Detection*, that they hugg'd

themselves over it, as a finish'd Work: So far from any Purpose of *Confession*, that they bless'd themselves for it, as a brave Achievement. The Sense of *Punishment*, even when the Affair had miscarried, could extort no Discovery; much less could *Pity*, or any other *Principle* do it, whilst it was in Agitation. To this Day We do not find They are asham'd of the Thing, or afflicted at any Part of it, bating the *Disappointment*. The Picture of an *English Jesuit*, who was principally concern'd in it, is now shown at *Rome* among the *Rarities* of the *Place*, and preserved there as a venerable *Relique*: This looks like recommending the Crime to Posterity, and facing the present *Solemnity* out of Countenance. This tells us that if more such *Champions* for the *Romish See* are to be met with, their Merits shall not go unrewarded: And consequently, what Cause *We* have to be still upon our Guard, and to keep up the *Anniversary Memorial*, not only by way of *Thankfulness* for what is past, but of *Warning* too for the future.

No Danger could insensibly be nearer the very Act and Minute of Accomplishment. The whole *Scheme* was laid; The gloomy *Theatre* prepar'd; The fatal *Materials* ready; The *Undertakers* resolute; The *nick* of Time at Hand, and nothing but a thin *Partition* betwixt the Regions of Light and Darkness, of Life and Death. Upon firm *Ground* we seemingly stood, not dreaming that without a Parable, *There was a great Gulf fixed*, and We inevitably to perish in it, unless some kind Messenger from the other World would inform us of the Hazard. The granting of that *deny'd* Petition seem'd now the only *Expedient* of our Rescue. How *slender* a *Support* at that Minute had the Fate and Felicity of *England*? Upon how *slight* a *Bottom* was our Hope and Happiness founded? A small *Surface* of Earth, the *Space* of a few Hours was all that Mediated betwixt us and Ruin: Then by a *Fate* not unlike to *Corah* and his *Company*, was the Earth to open and devour Us, tho' (thank God) for no *Fault* of the same Nature. If to every *Nation* there be, as some have thought, its *adverse*, and its *tutelary Angel*, we cannot doubt but the utmost Contest was betwixt *Them* at this critical *Period*; The One *eager* to push on our impending Overthrow, the Other as *Industrious* to prevent it.

No: What do we talk of *Tutelary Angels*? *If the Lord Himself had not been on our side, They had swallowed Us up quick*: To frustrate an Intention so cruel, and an Execution so certain, was *something* sure which *wanted* immediate *Providence*, and *worthy* of it also. To save a whole *Community*,

when upon the Brink of Peril, as little appriz'd of it, as they gave their Enemies Occasion to design it: To catch *Conspirators* in the Snares of their own *Policy*, and to plunge them into the *Pit* which they had prepar'd for Others: To guide inconsiderable *Causes* to the producing of wondrous good Effects, and to make accidental *Hints* the Means of mighty *Preservations*: All these, and many more Particulars of *this Day*, are plain Instances of Divine Interposal. Strange it was that such a Relenting *Message* should be sent at all, when the *Conspirators* were so hardened in *Bigotry*, and bandied together upon *Principle*! Stranger still that it should be so fortunately *misconvey'd* and come to a *Person* for whom it was not meant! Strangest of all, that being writ in such blind and ambiguous *Terms*, it should be so speedily and seasonably explained!

So many concurring *Circumstances*, when meeting in such a Momentous *Point*, cannot fairly be resolved into *Chance*, one of which had no manner of *Coherence* with the Other. How should the *King*, without some Glance of extraordinary *Light*, pierce into the horrid *Vault*, the hidden Store-house of Destruction? How without some Touch of a Prophetick *Spirit* should He ever think of that fatal *One* that was to blow up both the *Houses* of *Parliament*. The *Conjecture* at first Hearing must appear as *ridiculous*, as the *Fact* it self was *barbarous*; And the *Wit* of Man seem'd as incapable of hitting upon the *One*, as his *Malice* of committing the *Other*. But the less the natural *Likelihood* was, the greater was the Providential *Appearance*; And what might be laught at under the Notion of a *Humane* Guess, upon the Proof of the Thing we adore the more as *Divine* Discovery.

Never sure shall we cease to Adore the *Great Author* of our unexpected Safety, who rescued us at once from the *Fiery Furnace*, and from the *devouring Den*: Those Punishments which *Old Babylon* distinctly inflicted, the *New* had join'd together, as it were in One. How unwillingly were the base Workers of Iniquity expos'd to open *Day*, unable to bear it, because *their Deeds were reprov'd*? How happily did *We* escape the perpetual *Night* in which they sought to overwhelm Us? Loth were They to quit their private *Cell* wherein they labour'd for our Overthrow, as the Miner for his Oar, and counted our Ruin their *Riches*. But *Heaven* sent a sudden *Damp* upon their Designs, and the Weapons which they had formed in this *Hellish Forge* would not prosper.

So far was *God* from giving us up unto Destruction, that he suffer'd us not so much as to fear It, but scatter'd both the *Fear* and *Destruction* at once. No *Peril* was ever more imminent, and yet our Deliverance scarce put Us to the Expence of a *Fright*; And without Time for being troubled, We saw our *Danger*, and gave our *Thanks*. The *Plot* was just perfected to the clear *Conviction* and *Condemnation* of our Enemies; And yet conceal'd from Us, till 'twas prevented, that We might labour under no *Confusion*. Astonishing *Wisdom*! which knows how to let the *Wicked* prosper for a while, and yet at the same Time not to perplex the *Good*: So that in the Event the One may be more *justly* punish'd, the Other more *surprisingly* saved.

We have yet taken but a Half-view of this Happy *Day*. 'Tis famous for a *second Deliverance* of later Date, tho' very much of the same kind. The *Adversaries* the same, the *Hazard* as great, and the *Escape* at that Juncture not less welcom. *One* serves to heighten and advance the *Other*, tho' each of them singly stands above Acknowledgment. They both have a like Place in the *Offices* of the *Church*, and equally adorn its *Calendar*. To give as particular Relation of *This*, as of the *Former*, would be both Unnecessary and Indecent: *Unnecessary*, as copying only what is writ in your own Memory: *Indecent*, as seeming to call your Gratitude into Question.

Few here present have forgot the dreadful Apprehensions of approaching *Popery*: Not twenty Years are turn'd, since *Liberty* and *Religion*, the two great Blessings of Humane Life, were taking their flight from this melancholy *Island*. Unhappy *Britain* was putting on Her Chains, lay sunk and dispirited, fighting for *Relief*, but saw it not. That *Church* which is the Bulwark of the *Reformation*, was Her self defenceless; And *She* to whom her *Sister-Churches* fled for Refuge, thought of seeking the same favour, and could no where find it. Our *Ark* was actually tottering, and no one could put his Hand forth to uphold it, without feeling *Uzziah's* Fate: Not inflicted indeed for the same unwarrantable *Cause*, but equal to it in the *Certainty* of the Danger. We could not tell how soon our *Bibles* might be shut, and our *Temples*. It was already common with us to offer up our *Prayers* in an *unknown Language*, that I mean wherein we privately begg'd of *God* to defend his poor *Church*, but durst let none hear Us but our selves. The Fountains of *Education* were insensibly corrupted: What follow'd was no *Knowledge* at all, and *Superstition* in lieu of it. The *Host* was daily expected in our Streets, the next was *Flame* and *Faggot* for not

adoring it. I appeal to the dejected Looks, and down cast Eyes of every true *Protestant* at that Time, if it was not Thus. No Glimpse of Assistance all this while from *Heaven*, or any *Humane* Power. The former seem'd *angry*; The latter was *impotent*, and could not help Us.

Thus was *Darkness* and *Despair* spread over the Face of the whole *Kingdom*, till an *Invited Prince* rose from the *East*, and rejoiced with the Sun to begin his Course. We saw Him, as upon this *Day*, appearing with feeble Rays, with few *Forces*, attended tho' with united *Wishes*. His *Coming* was not with a *killing* Lustre, or with a Glory that *destroys*, whilst it *shines*; But all Folks then were refresh'd with the pleasing Sight, and felt a strange Revival. By his Presence He caus'd an *Effusion* of Joy, but none of *Christian Blood*. The farther he advanc'd, his *Influence* was found the more agreeable. *Slavery* and *Idolatry* instantly vanish'd, and the Shades of *Superstition* fled before Him. The *Emissaries* of *Rome*, those Creatures of Prey, got them away together, and laid them down in their Dens. Into Holes and Corners they retir'd, haunted by the Guilt of their ill *Counsels*, and as forward to desert an *unhappy Prince*, as formerly they had been to Mislead Him. We, in the mean Time, wrapt up in *Silence* and in *Wonder*, where wholly like to them that Dream. To us the *Deliverance* seem'd meer *Vision*, and the Surprise into which it cast Us, would scarce allow us to think it *Real*. Our *Rescue* was well nigh over, as soon as undertook, and we lifted up our *Heads* to see a Safety obtained, in which our *Hands* had no share. The only *Difficulty* We were then left under was how to prize and honour our *Deliverer* enough. We judg'd it as impossible ever to be unthankful for the seasonable *Relief*, as once it seem'd so, ever to obtain it; And we could repine at nothing (how much soever We have done it since) but at our own *Inability*, justly to acknowledge so great an *Undertaking*.

May this Auspicious *Day* ever bear a bright Figure in the *English Annals*, and continue, as it always has been, the Ornament of *History*, and Shame of *Popery*. May the glad *Celebration* of it run down to late Posterity, and so keep those Blessings upon perpetual Record, which otherwise, as at present they are too big to be own'd; so in an Age or two would seem too great to be believ'd. 'Tis but fitting the *Church* should observe a *Festival*, from which she dates her double Preservation; And we cannot fairly grudge the Day a Share in her Service, when without it the Whole had been lost. It has in former Time been thought, that the Conjunction of Stars made some

Days particularly successful to Persons, or Nations: But our Faith upon this Occasion carries Us above Those, and puts us under a higher and a better Aspect; namely, that of a wise and benign Providence. Heaven will not allow us to be ungrateful, when we are thus critically and opportunely reminded, twice I mean on one Day. This confirm'd Experience gives us cause enough to conclude with the last Words of this Psalm: *Our Help standeth in the Name of the Lord, who hath made Heaven and Earth.*

FINIS.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK A SERMON
PREACH'D UPON THE OCCASION OF THE ANNIVERSARY
THANKSGIVING OF THE FIFTH OF NOVEMBER, 1706 ***

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A
SERMON

Preach'd upon the Occasion of the

Anniversary Thanksgiving

Of the Fifth of *November*, 1706.

AT THE
CHURCH of *KENSINGTON*.

By NATH. HOUGH, M. A. Chaplain to the
Countess FAUCONBERG, Lecturer of *Ken-*
sington, and Fellow of *Jesus* College in
Cambridge.

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